

Nicholas A. Potter

Research Agricultural Economist

USDA Economic Research Service, Conservation and Environment Branch

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Education

- 2021 **Doctor of Philosophy**, Economics, Washington State University, Pullman WA, USA
Fields: Environmental Economics, International Trade
- 2005 **Master of Science**, Applied Mathematics, University of Massachusetts – Amherst, Amherst MA, USA
- 2002 **Bachelor of Arts**, Economics, Hampshire College, Amherst MA, USA

Research Experience

Research Agricultural Economist 2021 – Present

United States Department of Agriculture, Economic Research Service

- Conducted rigorous economic research on water resources and agriculture using confidential and public data sources, writes official research reports for public, policy, and research audiences, and reviews interagency research and policy outputs

PhD Research Assistant 2016 – 2021

Washington State University

- Utilized HPC clusters to conduct research on climate impacts on agriculture using satellite-based climate data and administrative datasets

Research Associate 2012 – 2016

Washington State University Center for Sustaining Agriculture and Natural Resources

- Engaged in research on pesticide residues and nutritional content on organic and conventionally produced agricultural products

Research Assistant 2011 – 2013

National Bureau of Economic Research

- Developed code and conducted causal analysis using confidential panel data on individuals participating in the Moving to Opportunity project

Teaching Experience

Instructor, Fundamentals of Microeconomics 2018

Washington State University

- 211 students, rated 4.2 out of 5

Certifications:

- Data and Software Carpentry Instructor 2018

Peer Reviewed Publications

- Yourek, M., Daniel Haller, **Nicholas A. Potter**, Kirti Rajagopalan, Kairon Shayne D. Garcia, and Jon Yoder. 2026. Water right forfeiture in Washington state from 1967 to 2019, Water Policy. <https://doi.org/10.2166/wp.2026.096>.
- Cameron-Harp, Micah, Nathan Hendricks, and **Nicholas A. Potter**. 2024. Predicting the spatial variation in cost-efficiency for agricultural greenhouse gas mitigation programs in the U.S., Carbon Balance and Management, 19(6). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13021-024-00252-6>.
- **Potter, Nicholas A.** 2019. rnassqs: An R package to access agricultural data via the USDA National Agricultural Statistics Service (USDA-NASS) 'Quick Stats' API. Journal of Open Source Software, 4(43), 1880, <https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.01880>.

Other Publications

- **Potter, Nicholas A.**, R. Aaron Hrozencik, and Steven Wallander. 2025. Irrigation Organizations – Organization Types and Governance. Economic Brief No. EB-45. U.S. Department of Agriculture, Economic Research Service. <https://doi.org/10.32747/2025.9458839.ers>.
- Hrozencik, R. Aaron, **Nicholas A. Potter**, and Steve Wallander. 2025. Irrigation Organizations – Water Measurement and Pricing. Economic Brief No. EB-40. U.S. Department of Agriculture, Economic Research Service. <https://doi.org/10.32747/2025.9015825.ers>.
- Hrozencik, R. Aaron, **Nicholas A. Potter**, and Steven Wallander. 2023. The Cost-Effectiveness of Irrigation Canal Lining and Piping in the Western United States. In Libecap, Gary and Ariel Dinar (Eds.), *American Agriculture, Water Resources, and Climate Change*. University of Chicago Press.
- **Nicholas A. Potter**. 2025. Normalized Prices. ERS Data Product. U.S. Department of Agriculture, Economic Research Service. <https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/normalized-prices/>.
- **Potter, Nicholas A.**, R. Aaron Hrozencik, and Steven Wallander, 2023. Irrigation Organizations – Water Inflows and Outflows, Economic Brief No. 36. U.S. Department of Agriculture, Economic Research Service. <https://doi.org/10.32747/2023.8134139.ers>.
- Hrozencik, R. Aaron, Grant Gardner, **Nicholas A. Potter**, and Steve Wallander. 2023. Irrigation Organizations – Groundwater Management, Economic Brief No. 34. U.S. Department of Agriculture, Economic Research Service. <https://doi.org/10.32747/2023.7975545.ers>.

Working Papers

- **Potter, Nicholas A.** and Jonathan Yoder. Water rights on the frontier: An economic model of forfeiture.

Conference Papers/Presentations

- **Potter, Nicholas A.** and R. Aaron Hrozencik. 2023. Accounting for Non-Local Climate in Estimating Climate Impacts on Agriculture. Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting, Washington, DC.
- **Potter, Nicholas A.** and R. Aaron Hrozencik. 2023. The Economic Implications of Declining Snowpack for Tribal and Irrigated Agriculture Water Supplies. Universities Conference on Water Resources (UCOWR), Fort Collins, CO.
- **Potter, Nicholas A.** 2023. Plant Early, Plant Often: Extreme Heat Impacts depend on Winter Climate. Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE) Summer Conference, Portland, ME.

- **Potter, Nicholas A.** 2022. Measuring the Implications of Declining Snowpack on Surface Water Availability and Irrigated Agriculture. The Workshop on Environmental Economics and Data Science (TWEEDS), Eugene, OR.
- **Potter, Nicholas A.** 2022. Measuring the Implications of Declining Snowpack on Surface Water Availability and Irrigated Agriculture. AGU Chapman conference on Solving Water Availability Challenges through an Interdisciplinary Framework, Golden, CO.
- Hrozencik, R. Aaron, **Nicholas A. Potter**, and Steven Wallander, 2022, A National Estimate of Irrigation Canal Lining and Piping Water Conservation, NBER Workshop: Economic Perspectives on Water Resources, Climate Change, and Agricultural Sustainability, Online.
- **Potter, Nicholas A.** and Jonathan Yoder. 2019. On the Frontier of Water Rights: Beneficial Use and Relinquishment in Settling the Columbia River Basin. Universities Conference on Water Resources (UCOWR), Snowbird, UT.
- **Potter, Nicholas A.**, Michael Brady, and Kirti Rajagopalan. 2018. Climate Impacts on Agricultural Productivity in the Fruitful Rim. 9th Annual Northwest Climate Conference, Boise, ID.
- **Potter, Nicholas A.**, Michael Brady, and Kirti Rajagopalan. 2018. Using Climate Analogues to Obtain a Causal Estimate of the Impact of Climate on Agricultural Productivity. Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting, Washington, DC.

Technical Skills & Certification

- **Programming & Tools:** R, Python, Git/GitHub, Docker, Claude Code, Codex.
- **Research Methodologies:** Causal inference, spatial analysis, high-performance computing (HPC)

Service

Peer Review

- 2026: Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy, 1 article
- 2024: Journal of Open Source Software, 1 article, 1 software package
- 2024: AAEA Summer Conference, 5 abstracts
- 2023: R Open Science Consortium, 1 software package
- 2023: Journal of Open Source Software, 1 article, 1 software package
- 2023: Natural Resource Modeling, 1 article
- 2021: AAEA Summer Conference, 4 abstracts

Other Service

- 2021: Mentor, USDA Pathways Internship
- 2018-2021: Instructor, Software and Data Carpentries